IT Change Management Procedure

Changes

Every change to a production system is requested in the IT service desk system with a description, a risk rating, a test result and a rollback plan.

Approval

A low risk change is approved by the IT team lead. A medium or high risk change is approved by the Change Board, which meets every Tuesday and Thursday at 10:00 am.

Freeze periods

No changes to the core banking system or the mobile money switch are made during month-end close, which runs from the last working day to the third working day of the next month, or during the December freeze from 15 December to 5 January.

Emergency changes

An emergency change is made to restore service or close a serious security hole. The IT duty manager may approve it alone. The change is recorded in the service desk system within one working day and reviewed by the Change Board at its next meeting.

Testing and rollback

Every change is tested in the test environment first. The rollback plan says who reverses the change, how long it takes and what data would be lost. A change without a tested rollback plan is not approved.

Communication

The change owner tells affected departments at least two working days before a medium or high risk change. Branches are told by the Branch Operations duty officer. The message says the date, the time, the expected effect and who to call.

Review after the change

The change owner confirms within one working day that the change worked. A change that caused an incident is reviewed in a post-incident meeting within five working days, and the lessons are added to the change checklist.